EAST WEST UNIVERSITY

Term Paper

Title: Natural Gas Crisis in Bangladesh and Its Impact on Economic Growth and Society.

Course Title: Composition and Communication Skills

Course Code: ENG7102

Section: 45

Submitted to:

Syeda Shabnam Mahmud

Senior Lecturer
Department of English
East West University

Submitted by:

Farjana Yasmin(2025-1-10-265)(**Green**)

Md Hasibul Islam (Hasib)(2025-1-10-105)(**Purple**)

Md Atiqur Rahman (2025-1-60-056)(**Blue**)

Date: 10/04/2026

Table of Contents

Contents	Page No.
• Introduction	2
• Significance of the Topic	2
• Findings from Research	3
• Findings from Students	4
• Authors' Reflection	5
• Conclusion	5
• References	6
• Appendix	6

Introduction

Regarding the sources of energy, it goes without saying that natural gas constitutes a major source of energy in the daily life of people in Bangladesh. People in Bangladesh rely on natural gas for their industries and household activities (like cooking) due to its relative inexpensiveness. In this respect, natural gas constituted the main source of energy in the country for a long period of time.

It is important to note that nowadays Bangladesh faces some problems with natural gas. The point is that the rapid development of the industrial sector and the growth of the country's population led to the increased need for natural gas. Meanwhile, the supply of natural gas was unable to meet these needs. Thus, industries were unable to provide the needed level of production, whereas people faced the shortage of natural gas.

Significance of the Topic

It is vital to carry out research on the issue at hand since it is significant for the country's national economy and its population. The gas industry is highly significant as one of the energy sources in the nation. If a crisis occurs in this sector, then it will have repercussions for all aspects of life in society. For example, industries require adequate gas supplies in order to enhance their production capacity. This will result in some problems economically in the state. However, there are no adequate supplies of gas for the citizens.

Findings from Research

The article named “Indigenous and imported natural gas and the economic growth of Bangladesh: The challenges ahead” written by Firoz Alam, Khondkar Saleque, Quamrul Alam, Israt Mustary, Harun Chowdhury, discussed the energy crisis in Bangladesh, with much emphasis being placed on natural gas as an important part of the energy source in the country. The article notes that in Bangladesh, there is a heavy reliance on natural gas not only for the production of electricity but also for various industries and households' needs. However, the demand for energy is rising as a result of increased population and economic growth, whereas natural gas supply is low and is getting smaller every year.

As per the findings, the remaining gas reserves can only serve Bangladesh for some more years at the current rates of its consumption. The analysis is based on information obtained from various sources, including the World Bank and different energy organizations.

The results indicate that excessive dependence on natural gas is one of the critical issues in Bangladesh. There should be consideration of other sources of energy, such as coal, nuclear energy, and even renewables.

This study, “Energy crisis in Bangladesh: Challenges, progress, and prospects for alternative energy resources” written by Md. Shafiqul Islam , Abul Quasem Al-Amin, Md. Sujahangir Kabir Sarkar; shows that Bangladesh is struggling from its energy supply to demand gap. From 1990 to 2018,energy use has increased 3 times but the supply still lags 26% backward demand. As a result frequent load shedding occurs that hampers our daily life and industrial output. Natural gas remains the main fuel, but known reserves are expected to be empty within 10–15 years. Despite having over 3 billion tonnes of coal, extraction remains minimal due to weak policies and environmental issues .76% of the population is connected to the electricity but it is unsmooth , only 42% of rural households have power which also uneven.Per capita electricity usage is 348 kWh annually, which is far below from India and Pakistan. Plans were taken by the government to shift toward coal, nuclear, and renewables have made limited progress; renewable energy achieved only 1.5% of its 2020 target by 2015.Fragile infrastructure, transmission losses, and bureaucratic inefficiencies worsen the situation. More than half of all businesses cite unreliable power as a major obstacle to growth. Addressing the crisis requires stronger governance, policy reforms, energy conservation, regional cooperation, and serious investment in education and research.

The article, “Present scenario of natural gas consumption and its relation with economic growth in Bangladesh” written by Mosrat Jahan, talks about the “correlation between natural gas consumption and economic growth of Bangladesh from 1990 to 2013”. Natural gas is the primary energy source of Bangladesh and takes up three-quarter of entire commercial energy consumption. Several sectors are dependent on natural gas such as fertilizer production(urea, ammonia), industries, transportation, household etc. However, it is mostly used for producing electricity (about 41%). In the article, the author uses a regression model to show the gas consumption dependency on GDP. There was a 99% in R-square value, which suggests a strong correlation between gas consumption and GDP; if GDP increases then gas consumption will increase. Therefore, it helps to grow the economy of Bangladesh. Finally, Ms. Jahan suggested using alternative energy sources such as coal, renewable energy to produce electricity and to reduce the reliance on natural gas.

Findings from Students

We have conducted a survey among students on our topic; 20 students have shared their opinion with us through 2 open ended questions and 6 closed ended questions. We’ve noticed a high awareness among students about the natural gas crisis in Bangladesh (95%). Most of the students have experienced supply shortages of gas. Moreover, about 80% have noticed the increasing household expenses. Which affects their social and economic life. Additionally, more than half of the students have switched to alternative energy sources (LPG, electricity etc.).

The majority of students believe that this crisis has obstructed Bangladesh’s economic growth and the government is not taking necessary steps. Response of open end questions suggest that high demand but low supply, poor management, recent war and weak infrastructure are the reasons for this shortage. Recommended solutions are to improve management, discovery of new gas fields, efficient use and diversification of energy sources.

Authors' Reflection

Natural gas is undoubtedly a valuable resource for Bangladesh. Given the current crisis of natural gas, we chose the topic "Natural Gas Crisis in Bangladesh and Its Impact on Economic Growth and Society". We believe that an in-depth understanding of the issue will take us a step closer to the solution. Shortage in the supply of natural gas is resulting in a deficit production of the electricity; thus, affecting the social life and economic growth of Bangladesh. It is also affecting several sectors (such as agriculture, transportation, industry etc.) that depend on natural gas. However, we don't perceive this dependency negatively; rather, it could be the possible beginning of transitioning to new energy sources. It is high time for Bangladesh to diversify its reliance on natural gas to new energy sources. The government should take initiatives to implement the use of new energy sources. Meanwhile, we should come up with efficient ways to use natural gas that could potentially extend our current gas reserve of 10-15 years.

Additionally, the government should import LNG gas to tackle the current rising demand for gas. We believe that both nuclear and renewable energy can be a great replacement for natural gas. Discovery of new gas fields could also help us to avoid this crisis.

Conclusion

The natural gas shortage in Bangladesh has moved beyond industrial problems and is now an actual, everyday struggle for households. Research confirms that the country's economic growth remains heavily dependent on a resource whose known reserves are only expected to last for just over ten more years.The survey findings reveal that this is not abstract data; 95% of students are aware of the pinch, from rising expenses to overturn routines. While the correlation between gas usage and GDP growth once signaled improvement , that heavy dependency now signals a main weakness. Businesses fail to meet production targets, and families either have to be content with inadequate supplies or spend more money on other alternatives.Temporary imports alone are not enough to navigate the future; it requires cultural and infrastructural shifts towards renewable and nuclear alternatives. These challenges represent a potential turning point for Bangladesh, allowing the country to move away from its risky dependence on a single energy source and towards a more diverse and sustainable electricity mix.

References

Alam, F., Saleque, K., Alam, Q., Mustary, I., & Chowdhury, H. (2019). Indigenous and imported natural gas and the economic growth of Bangladesh: The challenges ahead. *Energy Procedia, 160*, 18–25. https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S187661021931197X

Islam, M. S., Al-Amin, A. Q., Sarkar, M. S. K. (2021). Energy crisis in Bangladesh: challenges, progress, and prospect for alternative energy resources. *Utilities Policy, 71. https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0957178721000552*

Jahan, M. (2015). Present Scenario of Natural Gas Consumption And its Relation with Economic Growth in Bangladesh. *SSRN Electronic Journal ,* p:11 https://www.academia.edu/98615766/Present_Scenario_of_Natural_Gas_Consumption_and_Its_Relation_with_Economic_Growth_in_Bangladesh

Appendix

1. What, in your view, is the primary reason behind the gas crisis?
2. What do you believe is the lasting solution to Bangladesh's natural gas problem?
3. Do you know about the ongoing natural gas crisis in Bangladesh?
4. Have you faced gas supply shortages over the past year?
5. Has the gas crisis led to a rise in your household costs?
6. Have you switched to other energy sources (such as LPG, electricity, or biomass)?
7. Do you feel the natural gas crisis is hindering Bangladesh's economic development?
8. Do you believe the government is handling the gas crisis well?